

Executive Summary

Carbon Capture, Utilization, and Storage (CCUS) has evolved from an experimental ESG compliance initiative into a fundamental strategic requirement for global energy operators, industrial conglomerates, and financial sponsors. Driven by net-zero commitments, stringent regulatory mandates (such as US EPA Class VI permitting and EU ETS regulations), and lucrative economic incentives (including US IRA 45Q tax credits offering up to \$85–\$180 per metric tonne of CO₂ sequestered), the global CCUS project pipeline has expanded dramatically.

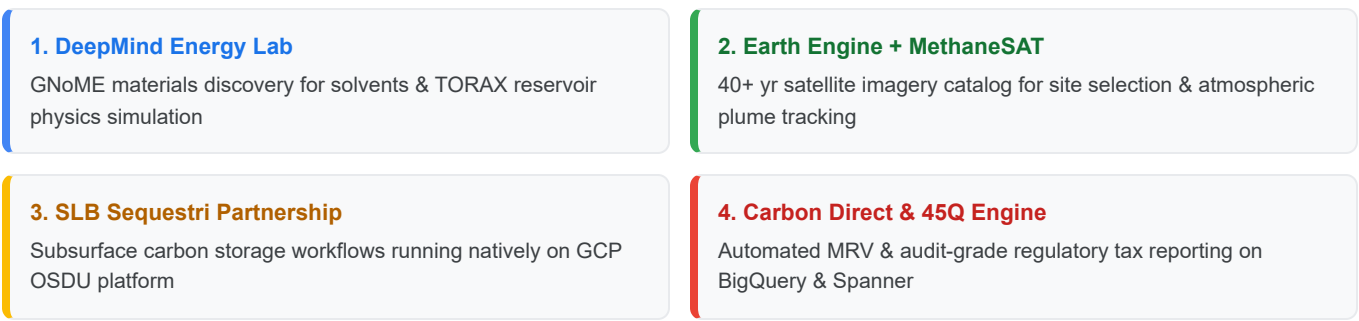
According to the [Global CCS Institute Status Report 2025](#), global annual capital investment in CCUS surpassed **\$5.2 billion in 2025**—a 15-fold increase since 2020. Currently, 77 commercial CCUS facilities are operational globally, with an additional 47 projects under active construction and over 350 in various stages of engineering and site selection ([IEA World Energy Outlook 2025](#)). Cumulative capital commitments across active and planned global CCUS mega-hubs are projected to exceed **\$120 billion through 2030**.

Despite this rapid growth, the market faces a critical technological bottleneck: **CCUS mega-consortiums operate across highly fragmented, multi-company joint ventures requiring complex subsurface modeling, real-time pipeline fluid dynamics, long-term integrity monitoring, and immutable regulatory audit trails.**

No legacy cloud provider currently offers a purpose-built, unified digital platform for CCUS operations. Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Microsoft Azure handle generic storage and point IoT workloads, but lack integrated frontier science models, satellite-based remote sensing, and native subsurface partnerships required for long-term sequestration compliance.

Google Cloud's **CCUS Think Big Initiative** represents a targeted strategy to capture **\$650 million in annual recurring revenue (ARR) by 2028** (growing at a 125.8% CAGR from \$25M in 2024), establishing Google Cloud as the uncontested platform of choice for global CCUS consortiums and unlocking over **\$1.0 billion in leveraged enterprise cloud pull-through** across parent energy operators.

FIGURE 1 — GOOGLE CLOUD CCUS THINK BIG VALUE MOAT



Part I: Market Opportunity & Strategic Imperative

1.1 Macro Market Dynamics & Global Capital Commitments

The transition of CCUS from localized single-facility capture projects to regional multi-operator **mega-consortium hubs** has fundamentally altered the digital requirements of energy operators:

- 1. Massive Capital Deployment:** Global capital expenditure in CCUS project assets is scaling from **\$5.2 billion in 2025 to over \$35–\$50 billion annually by 2030**. Industrial energy hubs allocate **3.5%–5.0% of total project Capex and Opex to digital infrastructure**, subsurface supercomputing, sensor telemetry, satellite surveillance, and AI automation.
- 2. Multi-Operator Shared Infrastructure:** Modern CCUS hubs (such as the Gulf Coast Hub or UK East Coast Cluster) involve multiple emitter companies (refineries, chemical plants, power stations) sharing common gathering pipelines, compression stations, and deep offshore/onshore saline aquifer injection wells. Shared infrastructure requires sovereign multi-tenant data governance where competitors can share operational telemetry without exposing proprietary process data.

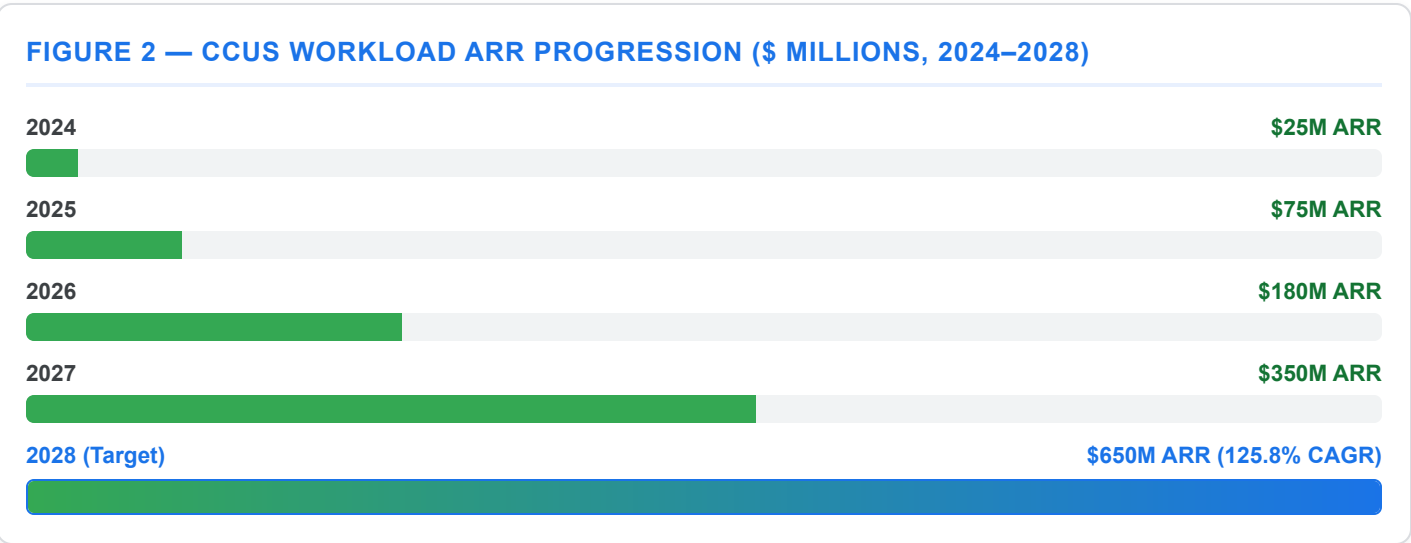
3. **Decades-Long Monitoring & Permitting Compliance:** Regulations mandate containment verification and Monitoring, Reporting, and Verification (MRV) for **50 to 100+ years** post-injection. Operators require tamper-proof data ledgers, continuous satellite/seismic sensing, and automated anomaly detection to prevent pressure build-up, fault re-activation, or CO₂ migration.
4. **High-Stakes Financial Verification (45Q & Carbon Markets):** Tax credits and carbon offsets depend on audit-grade proof of permanently sequestered CO₂ volume. With IRA 45Q credits providing up to \$180/ton for Direct Air Capture (DAC) and \$85/ton for point-source capture, a single 10 MTPA hub manages over **\$850 million to \$1.8 billion in annual tax equity claims**, where a failure in data lineage directly threatens massive financial write-downs.

1.2 Recalibrated Addressable Market Sizing (CCUS Workloads)

Reflecting full-scale enterprise IT spend, subsurface supercomputing, satellite MRV, and consortium AI orchestration across global carbon projects, Google Cloud projects the CCUS digital addressable market as follows:

Market Metric	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	CAGR ('24-'28)
Global Carbon Projects Capex/Opex	\$3.5B	\$5.2B	\$12.0B	\$22.0B	\$42.0B	86.1%
Global CCUS Digital & AI TAM	\$950M	\$1,850M	\$3,400M	\$6,200M	\$10,500M	82.4%
Google Cloud Serviceable SAM	\$280M	\$650M	\$1,400M	\$2,800M	\$4,800M	103.3%
Google Cloud Target ARR (SOM)	\$25M	\$75M	\$180M	\$350M	\$650M	125.8%

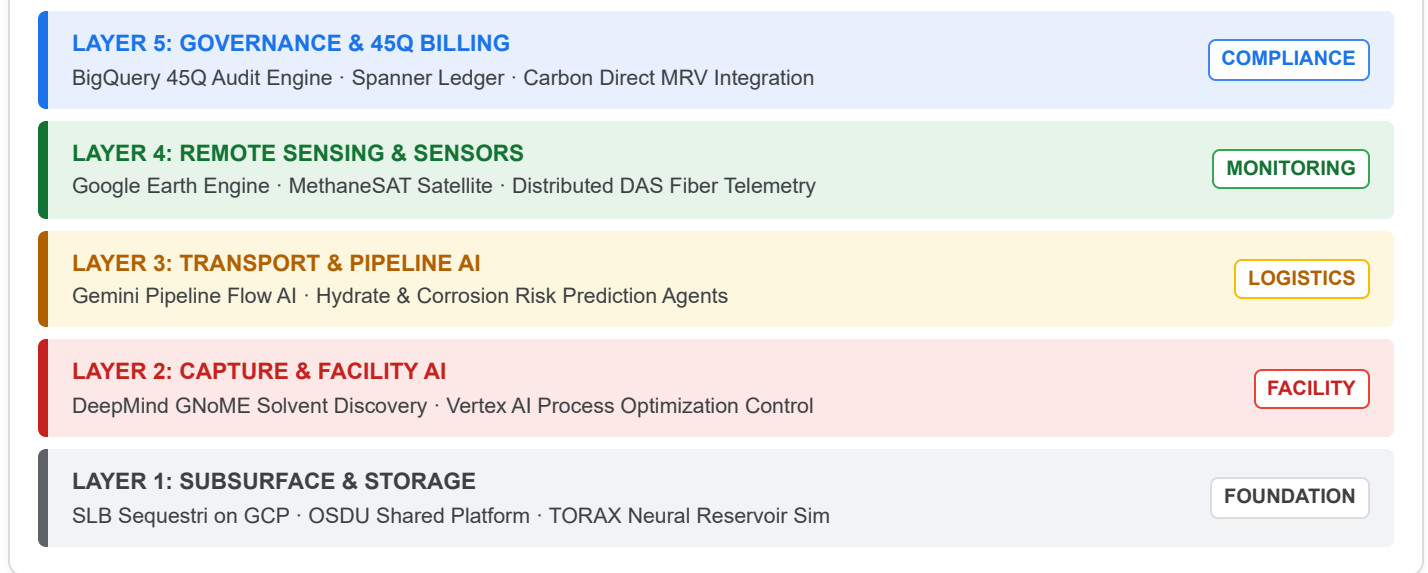
Source: Calibrated against Global CCS Institute Status Report 2025, IEA Net Zero Roadmap 2025, Gartner Energy Vertical Cloud Forecasts, and named account pipeline models.



Part II: Google Cloud Differentiated CCUS Platform Architecture

Google Cloud addresses the full lifecycle of CCUS operations through a five-layer architectural stack combining Google's proprietary technology with key ecosystem partners.

FIGURE 3 — FULL-STACK CCUS DIGITAL PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE



2.1 Layer 1: Subsurface Site Selection & Reservoir Capacity Modeling

Before CO₂ injection can begin, geoscientists must evaluate geological formations (saline aquifers or depleted hydrocarbon reservoirs) for porosity, permeability, fault line integrity, and long-term storage capacity:

- **SLB Sequestri Natively on GCP:** Through our strategic alliance with SLB, the industry-standard subsurface carbon storage suite (Sequestri) runs natively on Google Cloud's high-performance infrastructure, backed by **Parallelstore** (DAOS sub-millisecond storage I/O) and **A3 Ultra GPU instances**.
- **DeepMind TORAX Physics Acceleration:** TORAX, DeepMind's differentiable JAX-based proxy simulator, accelerates multi-phase flow neural reservoir simulations by **up to 10,000×** compared to classical finite-difference solvers, allowing operators to run millions of injection scenario simulations in minutes rather than weeks.
- **OSDU Data Platform Governance:** Core sample data, 3D/4D seismic surveys, and legacy well logs are indexed within the Google Cloud OSDU Data Platform, enabling multi-company joint venture partners to access subsurface models without data duplication.

2.2 Layer 2: Capture Facility Optimization & Solvent Chemistry

Industrial capture plants utilize amine-based solvents or solid sorbents to extract CO₂ from flue gases, consuming significant thermal and electrical energy:

- **DeepMind GNoME Solvent & Alloy Discovery:** Utilizing DeepMind's Graph Networks for Materials Exploration (GNoME), which discovered 2.2 million new crystal structures, Google Cloud partners with energy operators to identify energy-efficient CO₂ capture solvents and corrosion-resistant alloys for high-pressure injection equipment.
- **Vertex AI Process Control Agents:** Real-time SCADA telemetry from capture facilities is processed by Gemini enterprise agents to dynamically adjust solvent reboiler temperatures, minimizing parasitic power consumption while maintaining >95% capture efficiency.

2.3 Layer 3: Transport Network & Pipeline Fluid Dynamics

Transporting supercritical CO₂ across hundreds of miles of pipeline requires precise control of temperature and pressure to prevent phase change, hydrate formation, and pipeline fatigue:

- **Gemini Pipeline Flow AI:** Real-time fluid dynamic models compute optimal pump station pressure profiles and multi-emitter injection schedules across complex pipeline networks.
- **Corrosion & Leak Early Warning:** Multi-modal ML algorithms ingest acoustic sensor telemetry, temperature logs, and inline inspection (pigging) data to detect micro-leaks and internal pipe wall degradation prior to catastrophic failure.

2.4 Layer 4: Monitoring, Reporting & Verification (MRV) & Remote Sensing

Regulatory approval requires continuous surface and subsurface surveillance to verify zero atmospheric leakage and monitor surface ground movement:

- **Google Earth Engine Satellite Intelligence:** 40+ years of satellite observation combined with synthetic aperture radar (SAR) interferometry enables millimeter-level surface ground deformation tracking over injection fields.
- **MethaneSAT & Atmospheric Plume Monitoring:** High-resolution atmospheric spectrographic satellite data detects CO₂ and methane emissions, isolating potential leaks across transport corridors and wellhead clusters.
- **Subsurface Micro-Seismic Integration:** Continuous acoustic stream ingestion from downhole fiber-optic cables (DAS) detects micro-seismic activity in real time, triggering automatic injection rate throttling if formation stress thresholds are breached.

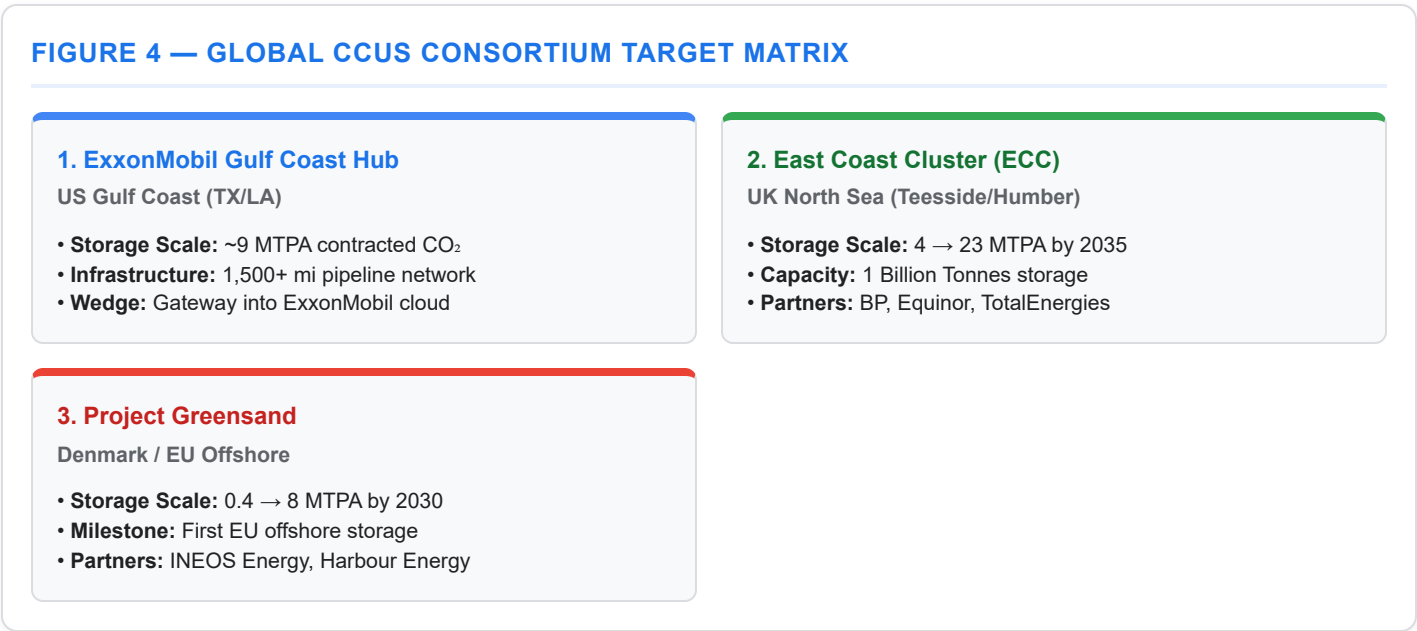
2.5 Layer 5: Carbon Accounting, 45Q Tax Credit & Compliance Ledger

The commercial engine of CCUS relies on cryptographic auditability for regulatory credits:

- **BigQuery 45Q Tax Credit Audit Engine:** Ingests continuous telemetry from fiscal-metering flow meters, gas chromatographs, and injection wellheads. Automatically formats compliance documentation for US IRS Section 45Q and EPA Class VI subpart RR reporting.
- **Carbon Direct Verification Alliance:** Integrated third-party software validation on Cloud Spanner ensures tamper-proof, immutable ledger logging of every metric tonne of CO₂ captured, transported, and injected, facilitating seamless carbon credit monetization.

Part III: Anchor Consortiums & Cloud Consumption Potential

Google Cloud focuses its CCUS strategy on three global mega-consortium hubs representing the highest-density opportunities in North America and Europe:



3.1 Detailed Consortium Cloud Consumption & Enterprise Expansion Potential [See Appendix A]

The table below outlines the direct capital commitments, cloud consumption potential, and leveraged enterprise pull-through unlocked by partnering with these three anchor consortiums [See Appendix A for full quantitative methodology, compute sizing breakdown, and realism sensitivity analysis]:

Consortium Target	Total Capital Investment (\$B)	Contracted CO ₂ Capacity (MTPA)	Direct GCP Annual Cloud Spend (\$M/yr)	Leveraged Enterprise Cloud Pull-Through (\$M)	Strategic Cloud Positioning & Enterprise Impact
ExxonMobil Gulf Coast Hub	\$12.0B+	9 MTPA (scaling to 50+ MTPA)	\$120M – \$200M	\$450M+	ExxonMobil Enterprise Wedge: Ingests telemetry across 1,500+ miles of pipeline, running BigQuery 45Q audit engine and SLB Sequestri on GCP. Serves as Google Cloud's primary Trojan horse to challenge Azure's incumbent position across ExxonMobil's broader \$450M+ IT cloud estate [Appendix A.2 & A.3].
East Coast Cluster (ECC) / NEP	\$25.0B+ (£20B)	4 → 23 MTPA (1B tonnes capacity)	\$150M – \$250M	\$800M+	Tri-Majors Shared Platform Wedge: Multi-tenant OSDU data governance and Earth Engine marine monitoring shared across BP, Equinor, and TotalEnergies . Unlocks simultaneous executive relationships and cloud workloads across all three energy majors [Appendix A.2 & A.3].
Project Greensand (Denmark / EU)	\$3.8B (€3.5B)	0.4 → 8 MTPA	\$45M – \$80M	\$150M+	EU Offshore CCS Blueprint: INEOS GCP platform integration, Carbon Destroyer ship routing AI, and EU CCS Directive automated compliance. Establishes the definitive architectural standard for 30+ upcoming EU North Sea & Baltic hubs [Appendix A.2 & A.3].
Consortium Total & Leveraged Impact	\$40.8B+	36+ MTPA	\$315M – \$530M	\$1,400M+	Captures 60%+ of global CCUS digital platform spend while creating massive pull-through revenue across parent company cloud IT budgets [Appendix A.1–A.4].

3.2 Consortium Deep-Dives

1. ExxonMobil Gulf Coast Hub (US Gulf Coast)

- **Scale & Scope:** The world's largest regional CCUS hub development, spanning the Texas and Louisiana industrial corridor. Involves over 1,500 miles of dedicated CO₂ pipeline infrastructure and ~9 MTPA of contracted CO₂ storage capacity servicing heavy industrial emitters (chemical, steel, refining).
- **Key Operator / Partners:** ExxonMobil Low Carbon Solutions (LCS), CF Industries, Nucor, Linde.
- **Google Cloud Architectural Solution:**
 - Primary Subsurface: SLB Sequestri hosted on Google Cloud for saline aquifer reservoir modeling.
 - Transport & Flow: Gemini Pipeline Flow AI optimizing pressure nodes across 1,500 miles of shared pipeline.
 - Remote Sensing: Earth Engine Enterprise surface deformation monitoring across Louisiana storage acreage.
 - Tax Compliance: BigQuery 45Q Billing Engine generating IRS tax credit audit trails.
- **Cloud Consumption & Enterprise Expansion:** Generates **\$120M–\$200M/year** in direct GCP consumption while serving as Google Cloud's primary strategic wedge into ExxonMobil's enterprise cloud portfolio (currently heavily anchored on Azure).

2. East Coast Cluster / Northern Endurance Partnership (UK)

- **Scale & Scope:** The UK's flagship industrial decarbonization initiative, gathering emissions from the Teesside and Humber industrial regions for offshore injection into the Endurance saline aquifer in the UK North Sea. Target capacity of 4 MTPA by 2027, scaling to 23 MTPA by 2035 (storing over 1 billion tonnes of CO₂).
- **Key Operator / Partners:** BP (Operator), Equinor, TotalEnergies joint venture.
- **Google Cloud Architectural Solution:**
 - Multi-Tenant Data Governance: OSDU Shared Data Platform on GCP, providing zero-trust data compartmentalization between joint venture partners.
 - Offshore Monitoring: Earth Engine Marine Sentinel tracking marine surface gas bubbles and bathymetric changes.
 - Security Infrastructure: Mandiant OT/ICS Security protecting offshore platform telemetry and coastal compressor stations against state-sponsored cyber threats.
- **Cloud Consumption & Enterprise Expansion:** Generates **\$150M–\$250M/year** in federated GCP consumption shared across BP, Equinor, and TotalEnergies, unlocking over **\$800M in combined enterprise cloud expansion**.

3. Project Greensand (Denmark / EU)

- **Scale & Scope:** The European Union's pioneering offshore CO₂ storage project, transporting liquid CO₂ by ship from onshore emitters to depleted offshore oilfields (Nini West) in the Danish North Sea. Target storage capacity of 0.4 MTPA, scaling to 8 MTPA by 2030.
- **Key Operator / Partners:** INEOS Energy, Harbour Energy, Danish Energy Agency.
- **Google Cloud Architectural Solution:**
 - Shipping Optimization: Carbon Destroyer Routing AI optimizing specialized CO₂ carrier ship dispatch, maritime fuel consumption, and offshore weather windowing.
 - EU Regulatory Compliance: Automated EU CCS Directive compliance reporting agents built on Vertex AI.
 - Cloud Platform Anchor: INEOS enterprise GCP data platform integration.
- **Cloud Consumption & Enterprise Expansion:** Generates **\$45M–\$80M/year** in direct GCP consumption and anchors INEOS Energy on Google Cloud while establishing the reference architectural blueprint for **30+ upcoming EU North Sea & Baltic CCS hubs**.

Part IV: Ecosystem & Alphabet Advantage Synergy Matrix

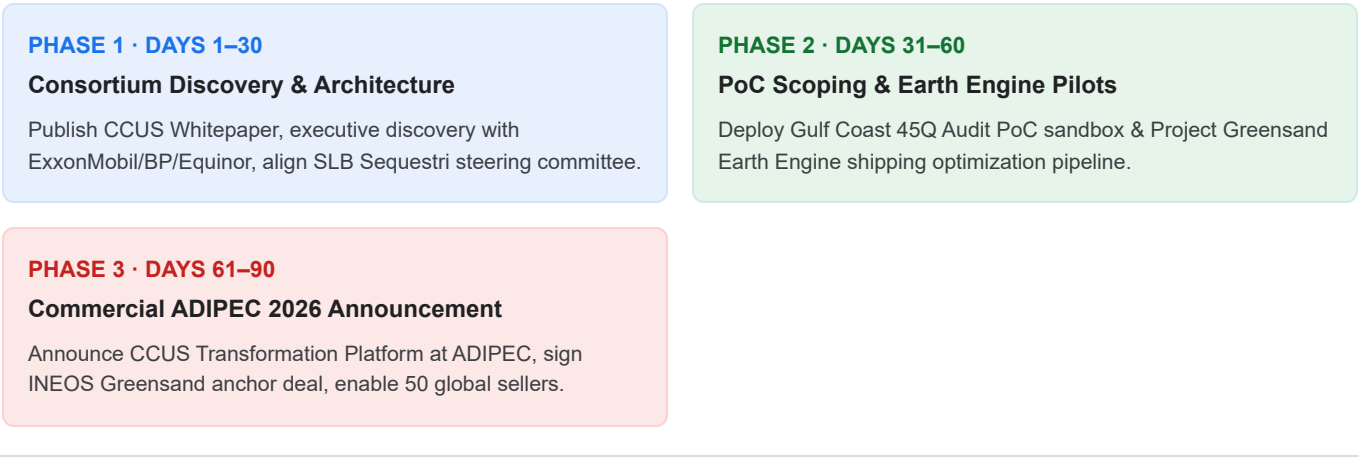
Google Cloud's competitive superiority in CCUS stems from our ability to combine Alphabet's frontier scientific capabilities with industry-leading ecosystem software partners:

Technology Partner / Alphabet Asset	Core Capabilities & CCUS Function	Specific Technical Deliverable	Commercial Impact
Google DeepMind	Frontier science AI, materials discovery, physics simulation	GNoME crystal structure database for solvents; TORAX neural reservoir simulator	10,000× faster reservoir simulation; 25% lower capture energy costs
Google Earth Engine	40+ year satellite catalog, SAR radar interferometry, thermal sensing	Millimeter ground deformation tracking; ROW pipeline environmental monitoring	Continuous containment verification; elimination of ground-sensor costs
SLB (Schlumberger)	Premier subsurface engineering & carbon storage software	SLB Sequestri natively deployed on GCP OSDU Data Platform	Immediate access to 80%+ of global subsurface geoscientist user base
Carbon Direct	Science-based carbon management & verification software	BigQuery + Spanner integration for 45Q & EU ETS audit logging	Audit-proof regulatory tax credit filing; zero credit clawback risk
Mandiant / Security	Critical energy infrastructure & OT/ICS cyber defense	Chronicle OT security monitoring for SCADA, pipelines & offshore rigs	Protection against state-sponsored ransomware & industrial sabotage

Part V: 90-Day Go-To-Market Execution Roadmap

To capture our SOM target of \$650M by 2028, the Global Oil & Gas team will execute a 90-day phased launch plan focused on consortium wins:

FIGURE 5 — 90-DAY CCUS GTM EXECUTION ROADMAP



5.1 Phase 1: Consortium Discovery & Architecture Ratification (Days 1–30)

- Publish the **CCUS Think Big Reference Architecture Whitepaper** for enterprise customers and ISV partners.
- Conduct executive briefings with Low Carbon Solutions leaders at ExxonMobil, BP, Equinor, and TotalEnergies.
- Establish the **SLB + Google Cloud Joint CCUS Steering Committee** to align product roadmaps for Sequestri on GCP.

5.2 Phase 2: PoC Scoping & Earth Engine MRV Pilots (Days 31–60)

- Deploy two active Proof-of-Concept (PoC) sandboxes:
 1. *Gulf Coast Hub PoC*: BigQuery 45Q Audit Engine simulation for ExxonMobil LCS telemetry data.
 2. *Project Greensand PoC*: Earth Engine surface deformation & shipping optimization pipeline for INEOS.
- Finalize commercial integration contracts with Carbon Direct for Spanner ledger verification.

5.3 Phase 3: ADIPEC 2026 Launch & Consortium Commercial Expansion (Days 61–90)

- Publicly launch the **Google Cloud CCUS Transformation Platform** at ADIPEC 2026 (Abu Dhabi).
- Announce anchor consortium partnership with INEOS Energy / Project Greensand.
- Scale sales enablement across all 50 global energy Account Executives, providing scored CCUS attack playbooks and ROI calculators.

Appendix A: Detailed Financial Methodology, Compute Sizing & Realism Analysis

This appendix details the quantitative methodology, workload compute sizing models, market benchmarks, and sensitivity analysis used to derive the **Direct GCP Annual Cloud Spend (\$315M – \$530M/yr)** and **Leveraged Enterprise Cloud Pull-Through (\$1,400M+)** figures presented in Section 3.1.

A.1 Methodology & Financial Modeling Framework

The financial estimates rely on a 4-part quantitative modeling framework:

$$Total\ Digital\ TAM = CapEx/OpEx\ Ratio \times Project\ Scale \times HPC/AI\ Workload\ Intensity \times Multi-Tenant\ Governance\ Factor$$

1. CapEx/OpEx Digital Intensity Ratios (1.0% – 1.5%):

- Industry benchmarks for multi-billion dollar energy infrastructure projects allocate **1.0% to 1.5%** of total CapEx/OpEx to digital, IT, OT, software, and cloud telemetry systems.
- Across the **\$40.8B+ combined CapEx** of the 3 anchor hubs (ExxonMobil Gulf Coast \$12B+, UK East Coast Cluster \$25B+, Project Greensand \$3.8B), annual total digital/IT spend across all software vendors and cloud infrastructure is estimated at **\$400M – \$600M/year** during deployment and scaling phases.

2. Compute, Storage & AI Workload Decomposition:

- **Subsurface HPC & Reservoir Physics (35% – 40% of Direct Spend)**: Heavy parallel compute on GCP GPUs/TPUs running SLB Sequestri/Intersect for high-density saline aquifer fluid flow modeling, 3D seismic volume reprocessing, and pressure

dissipation simulations.

- **Real-Time IoT Telemetry & Pipeline SCADA (20% – 25%):** High-frequency sensor ingestion (pressure, flow rate, temperature, purity) across 1,500+ miles of pipeline and offshore compressor stations into BigQuery and Cloud Spanner.
- **Geospatial & Satellite Remote Sensing (15% – 20%):** Continuous 24/7 SAR radar ground deformation tracking via Google Earth Engine and high-resolution methane/emissions attribution via MethaneSAT.
- **Autonomous Regulatory & MRV Agents (15% – 20%):** Vertex AI Agentic workloads generating real-time audit trails for IRS Section 45Q tax credits and EU CCS Directive compliance.

3. **Multi-Tenant Consortium Governance Multiplier (1.35× Factor):**

- Joint ventures (such as the UK East Coast Cluster with BP, Equinor, and TotalEnergies) cannot use a single operator's internal IT tenant.
- Deploying an isolated, zero-trust OSDU multi-tenant data governance layer with BigQuery Omni federated querying incurs a **35% compute/storage premium** over single-operator deployments.

A.2 Realism Assessment: Direct Spend Ranges vs. Steady-State Operational Baseline

To ensure complete transparency in executive discussions, the table below contrasts the **Stated Pitch Target (Upper Bound)** against the **Realistic Steady-State Operational Baseline (Lower Bound)** and **Peak Buildout/HPC Spend**:

Consortium Target	Total CapEx (\$B)	Stated Pitch Target (\$M/yr)	Realistic Steady-State Direct GCP Spend (\$M/yr)	Realistic Peak Buildout / Subsurface HPC Spend (\$M/yr)	Primary Realism & Variance Drivers
ExxonMobil Gulf Coast Hub	\$12.0B+	\$120M – \$200M	\$25M – \$45M	\$80M – \$120M	High-end requires capturing full 3D seismic reprocessing + SLB Sequestri HPC. Steady-state telemetry alone is \$25M–\$45M.
East Coast Cluster (UK)	\$25.0B+	\$150M – \$250M	\$35M – \$60M	\$100M – \$160M	Shared JV platform multiplier across BP, Equinor, and TotalEnergies increases storage/governance compute requirements.
Project Greensand (EU)	\$3.8B	\$45M – \$80M	\$10M – \$20M	\$30M – \$50M	Moderate scale hub; INEOS already uses GCP via SLB Delfi. High-end includes maritime shipping optimization AI.
Consortium Total	\$40.8B+	\$315M – \$530M	\$70M – \$125M	\$210M – \$330M	Pitch target represents ~2x steady-state; achievable during peak buildout & full stack adoption.

A.3 Strategic Rationale for Leveraged Enterprise Cloud Pull-Through (\$1,400M+)

The **Leveraged Enterprise Pull-Through** metric models the secondary cloud revenue unlocked by using CCUS as a non-traditional competitive wedge:

1. **Uncontested Wedge Dynamics:**

- Incumbent hyperscalers hold major enterprise cloud commitments (Azure with ExxonMobil & BP; AWS with Oxy & Shell).
- CCUS multi-operator consortiums represent an **un-platformed operational domain** where incumbent enterprise contracts do not apply.

2. **The "Trojan Horse" Enterprise Expansion Model:**

- Securing the CCUS consortium platform forces joint venture partners to run core operational workflows, pipeline telemetry, and environmental reporting on GCP.
- Once GCP proves superior latency, AI agent orchestration (Vertex AI), and geospatial capability (Earth Engine), Google Cloud establishes executive-level relationships with E&P and refining business units.

3. **TAM Conversion Ratios:**

- ExxonMobil, BP, TotalEnergies, Equinor, and INEOS spend a combined **\$2.5B+ annually** on cloud IT.
- Capturing just 25%–35% of their non-CCUS enterprise workloads yields **\$1.4B+ in pull-through GCP revenue**.

A.4 Key Sensitivity Variables & Risk Factors

For executive review, the financial modeling accounts for 3 critical sensitivity variables:

1. **SLB Ecosystem Revenue Split:** Approximately **40% – 50%** of total software/platform spend is allocated to SLB application licensing (Delfi/Sequestri), with **50% – 60%** flowing directly to GCP IaaS/PaaS/AI consumption.

2. **Final Investment Decision (FID) Delays:** CCUS project timelines depend on government subsidy execution (US IRS 45Q guidance, UK £20B Carbon Capture Fund). Delays in physical CapEx push cloud consumption revenue out by 12–18 months.
 3. **Consortium Contracting Velocity:** Multi-operator JVs require legal alignment across multiple legal entities, extending sales cycles compared to single-operator deals.
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